

Frontier Capability Matrix

Choose the available path before starting Lab 10

PURPOSE

Use this matrix to choose Path A, B or C. Frontier is a Microsoft early-access programme and capability visibility may differ by licence, tenant, policy and rollout.

Capability	Best use in this lab	Required control	Fallback
Researcher	Multi-source option investigation	Citations, authority ranking, no final decision	Copilot Chat with attached sources
Analyst	Dataset profiling and calculation	Exclusions, formulas, denominators, definition warning	Copilot in Excel
Word Agent	Create decision paper	Approved TRUST pack only	Copilot in Word
PowerPoint Agent	Create steering deck	Use approved paper; verify all figures	Copilot in PowerPoint
Cowork	Prepare approved follow-up work	Stop at approval; no silent execution	Approved manual workflow
Researcher with Computer Use	Optional browser-based investigation	Use approved sites; verify captured evidence	Researcher without computer use

Path selection

Path	Minimum available	What changes
A — Full Frontier	Researcher + Analyst + Office agents	Complete all handoffs in Frontier
B — Partial	At least one named agent	Use available agent and in-app fallbacks
C — No Frontier	Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat and Office apps	Complete the same evidence controls manually

Important distinction

FRONTIER IS NOT ONE AGENT

Frontier is the early-access programme where eligible Microsoft 365 Copilot users can try new capabilities. Researcher, Analyst, Office agents, Cowork and computer use have different purposes and availability.

Official references

Microsoft 365 Copilot Frontier
<https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/what-is-frontier>

Researcher
<https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-with-researcher-in-microsoft-365-copilot>

Analyst
<https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-with-analyst-in-microsoft-365-copilot>

Word, Excel and PowerPoint agents
<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/wordexcelppt-agents>

Cowork

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/cowork/>

Researcher with Computer Use

<https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/get-started-using-researcher-with-computer-use-in-microsoft-365-copilot-frontier>